

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



SUZANNE DECHILLO/THE NEW YORK TIMES

JIMMY CARTER 1924-2024

A president and peacemaker

Humanitarian and former Georgia governor founded The Carter Center, which champions democracy, public health and human rights

By Bill Barrow | Associated Press

Jimmy Carter, the peanut farmer who won the presidency in the wake of the Watergate scandal and Vietnam War, endured humbling defeat after one tumultuous term and then redefined life after the White House as a global humanitarian, has died. He was 100 years old.

The longest-lived American president died on Sunday, more than a year after entering hospice care, at his home in the small town of Plains, Georgia, where he and his wife, Rosalynn, who died at 96 in November 2023, spent most of their lives, The Carter Center said.

“Our founder, former U.S. President Jimmy Carter, passed away this afternoon in Plains, Georgia,” the center said in posting about his death on the social media platform X. It added in a statement that he died peacefully, surrounded by his family.

Businessman, Navy officer, evangelist, politician, negotiator, author, woodworker, citizen of the world — Carter

Tribune Editorial: For Jimmy Carter, the presidency was prologue. **Page 7**

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Turtles infected with rare fungus

Illinois leads in research and treatment

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

After putting on surgical gloves, Matthew Allender gingerly picked up a Blanding’s turtle to inspect it for signs of a rare fungal pathogen. The fungus was recently discovered in the state-endangered Blanding’s and red-eared slider turtles, underscoring the importance of conservation efforts across Illinois.

The first documented cases of *Emydomyces testavorans* in the state were part of a study published in October in the Journal of Wildlife Disease, which was led by researchers from the University of Illinois Wildlife Epidemiology Lab and the Brookfield Zoo, where Allender is director of conservation, medicine and science.

Tucked into her shell, the turtle he held refused to be examined. So he reached for her front

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Iseoluwa Adegbite, 7, left, and mother Omotunde Adegbite wait for the CTA 4 bus at East 63rd Street and South Cottage Grove Avenue in Chicago’s Woodlawn neighborhood on Dec. 10. **TESS CROWLEY/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

CTA says bus service is back to prepandemic levels

Analysis shows which neighborhoods were slowest to return to normal

By Sarah Freishtat
Chicago Tribune

Sheridan Fitzpatrick stopped taking the bus to work some two years ago when the waits became too long and passengers on board became too disrespectful.

She recalled one instance when, with snow on the ground, she waited an hour for a bus that

never arrived.

So she bought a car and now drives to her job at Daley’s Restaurant in Woodlawn.

“I rode the bus for years and years before that, because I had to,” she said.

In the two years since Fitzpatrick stopped taking the bus, the CTA continued to struggle to provide frequent, reliable service. The agency first cut bus

schedules to try to boost reliability and then began adding back service. Officials said scheduled service returned to prepandemic levels a few days before Christmas.

But a new analysis shows that some neighborhoods were slower than others to get back planned service — and many of the neighborhoods that fared the worst have particularly high unemployment rates and

Turn to Bus, Page 2

Chicago-area doctors turning to AI more often

Technology helps take notes during patient visits

By Lisa Schencker
Chicago Tribune

It was easy to miss Dr. Robert Gray’s quick movements, tapping the screen of his smartphone at the beginning and end of patient visits on a recent day.

But Gray said those fast finger taps have changed his life. He was tapping an app that records discussions during his appointments and then uses

artificial intelligence to find the relevant information, summarize it and zap it, within seconds, into each patient’s electronic medical record.

The technology was meticulously documenting each visit so Gray didn’t have to.

“I enjoy working so much more,” said Gray, an Endeavor Health hand surgeon. He’s no longer trying to consult with patients while simultaneously summarizing the visits on a computer. “I don’t have the feeling I got

Turn to Doctors, Page 4



Orthopedic surgeon Robert Gray, right, meets with a patient at his office in Skokie. Gray uses an Abridge listening and transcription app that’s made for medical professionals. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

